

BHASKAR PAUL

◀◀ **REWIND**

TRAIL OF TERROR



It was almost a recap of the well-coordinated 7/7 bombings in London the previous year as seven explosions, within a span of 11 minutes, tore through packed commuter trains during rush hour, killing over 187 people and injuring hundreds in Mumbai, the financial capital of the country. Ripping through the heart of the city, powerful bombs exploded between 6.24 p.m. and 6.35 p.m. at Matunga, Mahim, Bandra, Khar Road, Jogeshwari, Bhyander and Borivli. The plan hatched by Lashkar-e-Toiba's Azam Cheema was simple, and was executed over a period of three months. Seven two-member teams—each comprising one Indian and one Pakistani—placed pressure-cookers packed with RDX and ammonium nitrate on the luggage racks of first class compartments. The damage was great, but Mumbai was remarkably resilient. That the blasts were a result of a cross-border conspiracy was not lost on anyone, with Manmohan Singh stating, "We are certain that these terror modules are instigated, inspired and supported by elements across the border, without which they cannot act with such devastating effect."

FIRST CUT

- The US became "a friend, a well-wisher", to quote Prime Minister Manmohan Singh. Marking a turning point in bilateral relations, India and the US signed the Henry

J. Hyde United States-India Peaceful Atomic Energy Cooperation Act.

- The Thar Express in Rajasthan made its way to Pakistan from Jodhpur, after 41 years.

◀◀ DID YOU KNOW

India had a whopping 130 million mobile phone users in 2005, with the Capital joining the elite club of world cities thanks to the presence of over 10 million mobile phone users.